



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2022-23
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

General Instructions:

- The question paper consists of five printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.
- Writing time is not included in the reading time

SECTION A

I. Choose the most appropriate option: **[10]**

- a) I baked the cake _____ he made the pudding. (Fill in the blank with a suitable conjunction)
i. if ii. while iii. though iv. when
- b) Write this down _____ you should forget. (Fill in the blank with a suitable conjunction)
i. or ii. when iii. lest iv. if
- c) Have you _____ your lunch? (Fill in the blank with a suitable Tense)
i. eaten ii. eating iii. ate iv. will eat
- d) Choose the sentence with the correct position of Adverb.
i. Rita was greatly impressed by his performance.
ii. Rita was impressed greatly by his performance.
iii. Greatly was Rita impressed by his performance
iv. Rita was impressed by his performance greatly.
- e) Choose the sentence with the correct position of Adverb.
i. Mary watches TV hardly ever.
ii. Mary hardly ever watches TV.
iii. Hardly Mary watches TV ever.
iv. Hardly ever Mary watches TV.
- f) Did she do her duty? (Change the voice of the given sentence)
i. Was her duty being done by her?
ii. Had her duty done by her?
iii. Was her duty done by her?
iv. Had her duty being done by her?

- g) The athlete _____ the race because of an injury. (Fill in the blank with the correct word)
- i. will quit ii. quit iii. has quits iv. quits
- h) The boy laughed at the beggar. (Change the voice of the given sentence)
- i. The beggar was laughed by the boy.
ii. The beggar was being laughed at by the boy.
iii. The beggar being laughed at by the boy.
iv. The beggar was laughed at by the boy.
- i) That is as easy as shooting fish in a barrel. (Identify the figure of speech)
- i. Irony ii. Metaphor iii. Personification iv. Simile
- j) I was _____ by my parents for returning home late after the party. (Fill in the blank with a suitable Phrasal verb)
- i. taken to
ii. cast down
iii. pulled up
iv. done up

SECTION B

II. Write a composition (350-400 words) on any one of the following: [20]

- a) Summers are becoming hotter with each passing year. Write a description of one such very hot day. What did you see and hear as you walked outside? How were the birds and animals affected?
- b) Every home should adopt a pet animal. Express your views either for or against this statement.
- c) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



III. Select any ONE of the following:

[10]

- a) You have been given a small sum of money to buy a gift for a friend. Write a letter to your friend telling him/her about the gift you have chosen for him/her and how it will benefit him/her.
- b) Some taps in your locality are left open all day resulting in a tremendous waste of water. Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner of your city complaining about the problem. Suggest ways in which this wastage of water can be prevented.

IV. Write a Notice on the following topic.

[5]

The Kolkata Book Society is going to organize a week-long book fair in your school during the coming autumn vacation. It has requested your school for volunteers to manage various counters. As Secretary, Readers' Club write a notice inviting the names of students from classes VIII and IX who wish to help.

V. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

My husband Pele and I were staying in a holiday house overlooking the beautiful, lush rainforests of Indonesia. The glass walls framed a fine view across the Bagon Valley to what had been the summer palace of President Suharto. The first morning we strolled up a winding pathway, heading to the main building for breakfast. But once we arrived at the dining room, I realized we'd forgotten our money, so I volunteered to run back to the house. Making my way down the path, I turned the last corner only to find a giant bird, similar to an emu, standing outside our front door. "Hey baby, what are you doing?" I cooed, moving slowly so as not to frighten it. Having a deep, abiding fascination with all creatures great and small, I wanted a closer look. This was my first mistake. As I came within a few meters, he took a big breath and let out a nasty hiss, stopping me in my tracks. "That's not very friendly," I said, clueless. He hissed again and I promptly made the second mistake of turning and running, instead of backing away slowly. As I rounded the corner I heard his razor-sharp claws scrabbling on the cobblestones. "Oh!" His steps sounded like a drum as they hit the ground, quickly coming too close for comfort. I suddenly changed direction and headed into the trees. Dodged in and out of the foliage. I hoped my tactic would fool him. A crash behind me indicated no such luck. Jumping over a small bush, I found myself out in the open and not far from the dining room. Picking up speed, I bolted over the plants and rockeries surrounding the perimeter and dashed through the gate. When I turned to close it, the bird was nowhere to be seen. I didn't realize it at that time, but I had just come face to face with a cassowary, a bird also found in Australia's north Queensland rainforests. Cassowaries weigh 55 kilos or more, stand about 180 centimeters tall and have saber-like toenails that can open a human from chin to toe like a zipper and kill humans. "What's wrong?" Pele asked as I stumbled back into the dining room. "A big

bird chased me all the way from the house,” I replied. “What?” he asked incredulously. “You’re scared of a bird?” “It’s as big as me and very mean,” I said in a rather sulky voice. “Oh, all right,” he laughed. “I’ll come with you.” Much to Pele’s amusement, I stayed behind him on the path and held onto the back of his shirt as we approached the corner of the house. “See! There it is. Look at the size of the thing!” Pele chuckled at the hysteria in my voice. “It’s all right,” he soothed. Calmly and confidently, he walked toward the cassowary. “Shoo! Go on, get out,” he said. He made actions with his arms as if it were a pigeon on a window ledge. The response of the cassowary was the same as before: a big hiss and a step forward. “Hmm,” said Pele and stopped, not so sure of himself. He tried again. “Go on.” The cassowary then ran a few paces at us, hissing aggressively, so we quickly retreated around a corner of the house. Pele picked up a rock the size of his hand and threw it hard, hitting the bird squarely in the chest. It didn’t budge. “What are we going to do?” I pleaded. This time, Pele picked up a cane chair. “Stay behind and I’ll keep him back. When we get to the door, open it.” Again, I held on to the back of his shirt and we started towards the door. This greatly displeased the already annoyed cassowary. Charging at us he ripped at the chair with those lethal claws. Pele stopped to steady the chair – and possibly his resolve. Pele threw the chair at the bird and slammed the door shut. Ducking the flying cane, the bird ran straight at the glass wall, only to bounce off. But it didn’t slow down at all. Pecking and scratching at the glass, it continued the assault with a sickening ferocity. It was another 15 minutes before the bird weakened and slowed its attack. Thirty minutes later, we quietly opened the door and crept back to the main building.

- a) Give the meanings of the following words as used in the passage. One-word answers or short phrases will be accepted. [3]
- i) strolled
 - ii) fascination
 - iii) foliage
- b) Answer the following questions briefly in your own words.
- i) What was Pele’s wife’s first mistake when she saw the bird? [2]
 - ii) What was the lady’s third mistake? [2]
 - iii) When Pele’s wife realized that there was ‘no such luck’, what did she do? [2]
 - iv) Describe the Cassowary. [2]
 - v) Give a title to the passage and give a reason to justify your choice. [1]
- c) In not more than 50 words describe how the couple escaped the cassowary and returned to their room. [8]

VI. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate form of the word given in brackets. [4]

By the time Matilda was three, She had 1 (teach) herself to read by 2 (study) newspapers and magazines that 3 (lie) around the house. At the age of four, she could read fast and well and naturally began 4 (hanker) after books. The only book in this whole enlightened household was something called Easy cooking, 5 (belong) to her mother and when she read this from cover to cover and 6 (learn) all the recipes by heart, she 7 (decide) she 8 (want) something more interesting.

VII. Join the following sentences to make a complete sentences without using and, but or so. [4]

- a) The forest was dark and gloomy. Mr. Oliver travelled through it.
- b) Tina and Tara are twins. They look exactly alike.
- c) Sara pushed as hard as she could. The door would not open.
- d) She proposed the budget. It was accepted by all.

VIII. Do as directed: [7]

- a) The guide requested us to avoid the mountain path. (Begin: The guide said,)
- b) Is Ritika buying a table? (Change the voice of the sentence)
- c) This masterpiece has been created by her. (Change the voice of the sentence)
- d) The car complained as the key was roughly turned in its ignition. (Identify the figure of speech)
- e) My uncle is moving to Stockholm soon. (Use the adverb 'definitely' correctly)
- f) The defence lawyer failed to acquit his son in a case. (Identify the figure of speech)
- g) You will _____ a heavy loss if you do not manage your finances well. (Fill in the blank with a suitable Phrasal verb)